

France has never been ruled by a queen

Maria Teresa (1717–1780)

Maria became **EMPRESS OF THE AUSTRIAN EMPIRE** when her father, Charles VI, died. She reorganized Austria's army, and **introduced compulsory schooling**, which brought the flagging empire back to life. She had **16 children**, which included two queens, a few duchesses, and two Holy Roman Emperors.



Catherine the Great (1729–1796)

To become “great” this **RUSSIAN QUEEN** first got rid of her husband, the Emperor of Russia, Peter III. She then **increased the amount of land controlled by Russia**, and promoted education and the new philosophy of “*enlightened thinking*.” Unfortunately, all this only helped the rich, so the poor probably didn’t think she was that great at all.



Queen Victoria (1819–1901)

Victoria was only 18 when she became **QUEEN AND EMPRESS OF THE BRITISH EMPIRE**. She might have been short, but for 64 years she **ruled more than 450 million people** in an empire that covered a quarter of the globe. Her 42 grandchildren occupied the thrones of most of Europe, earning her the nickname “**the grandmother of Europe.**”

